

December

25

Imperial coronation

800

Charlemagne was crowned the first Holy Roman Emperor. He united most of western Europe under his rule, earning him the title *Pater Europea*, or “Father of Europe”.



1223

First nativity scene

To celebrate the story of Christ's birth, St Francis of Assisi set up the first nativity scene. It is now an annual tradition among many Christians.



Born this day

1642 Isaac Newton, English mathematician and physicist. He developed theories about gravity and motion.

1971 Justin Trudeau, Canadian prime minister. As leader of the Liberal Party, he was elected to power in 2015.

Christmas truce

1914

In the midst of World War I, British and German soldiers called a brief truce, halting battle to meet in No Man's Land. Some even played football together before returning to the trenches.



Also on this day

336 CE Christmas was celebrated on 25 December for the first time in recorded history.

1776 George Washington crossed the Delaware River during the American Revolutionary War, surprising his British opponents.

1831 The Great Jamaican Slave Revolt saw thousands of enslaved Jamaicans rebel in an unsuccessful attempt to gain their freedom.